

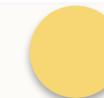
English SP

**“Master teaches a much-loved instrument”
“What your updates say about you”**

Open-ended questions

TODAY'S lesson

**10 Vocabulary items
11 Open-ended questions
(12 marks)
Focus skill: metaphor & simile**



Key vocabulary: match the meanings

1 comprise Line 37 G

2 intake Line 56 E

3 tuition Line 34 I

4 posture Line 40 D

5 unwittingly Line 6 B

6 assumption Line 15 H

7 disclosures Line 35 F

8 nocturnal Line 52 C

9 desperation Line 45 J

10 counterproductively Line 58 A

A. in a way that has the opposite result to the one you intended.

B. by accident; without realising what you are doing.

C. active or happening at night.

D. the position in which you hold your body when sitting or standing.

E. a group of people admitted at one time (e.g. a new class of students).

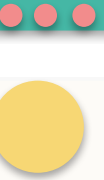
F. personal information that you reveal/make known to others.

G. to consist of; to be made up of.

H. an idea that you accept as true without proof.

I. money paid for lessons; (also) teaching itself.

J. a feeling of hopelessness / a strong need that makes you act without thinking.



Comparison questions — “Why is X compared to Y?”

The answer is the **QUALITY** the two things share — not the two things themselves.

SIMILE — the signal is written openly

- like · as ... as · compared to · similar to

e.g. The pressure before the public exams weighed on her shoulders like a mountain of lead.

→ the shared quality sits right next to the signal:
heavy — copy the quality, not the object

METAPHOR — the signal is hidden

- X IS Y — no “like” or “as” in the sentence

e.g. Landfills are ticking bombs that future generations have to deal with.

→ what do the two things share? Both are
dangerous and will cause harm later

How to answer:

- What do the two things **SHARE**? They are both ...
- Write the **QUALITY** (heavy · dangerous) — never just the object (a mountain · a bomb).
- Never write “because they are similar” — say **HOW** they are similar.

Let's try two comparison questions — then the 12-mark exam questions.

Simile — demo 1 (easy) • the signal is written openly

(demo — not from the examination paper)

The pressure before the public exams weighed on her shoulders like a mountain of lead.

Question: Why is the pressure compared to a mountain of lead?

Model answer: because the pressure felt very heavy / it weighed her down badly, like a mountain of lead

Metaphor — demo 2 (difficult) • the signal is hidden

(demo — not from the examination paper)

Landfills are ticking bombs that future generations have to deal with.

Question: Why are landfills compared to ticking bombs?

How to find it: no “like” or “as” — a metaphor says landfills ARE ticking bombs.

Ask what they share: both are dangerous and will cause serious harm later — the harm comes when we do nothing.

Model answer: because both are dangerous — they will cause serious harm later / if nobody deals with them now

Read the paragraph — then write your answer

1. When did the guzheng become popular?

since ancient times // during the Qin Dynasty

[1] The guzheng has been a popular Chinese instrument since ancient times originated during the Warring States period and first became popular during the Qin Dynasty.

Evidence & explanation

Text 2, ¶1: “a popular Chinese instrument since ancient times... first became popular during the Qin Dynasty.”

the answer is the TIME phrase — either reading is accepted.

(1 mark · 82%)

Read the paragraph — then write your answer

2. Find a word in paragraph 2 that means the same as “unstable”.

turbulent

[2] After surviving the turbulent time the Cultural Revolution, its popularity restored and today it is one of the most lc

Evidence & explanation

Text 2, ¶2: “After surviving the **turbulent** times of the Cultural Revolution...”

“**turbulent times**” = “unstable times”
— check the spelling.

(1 mark · 43%)

Read the paragraph — then write your answer

3. According to Zou Lunlun, why do Chinese people want to learn the guzheng?

they have been exposed to its sound since childhood

Evidence & explanation

Text 2, ¶3: “Chinese people are attracted to learning the guzheng **because** they have been exposed to its sound since childhood.”

“because” = reason signal — **copy the full clause.**

(1 mark · 85%)

[learning] the guzheng because they have been **exposed** to its sound since **childhood.**

15 Zou Lunlun, guzheng artist and founder of
International Academy for Musical Arts.

Read the paragraph — then write your answer

4. Use ONE word to complete each blank.

Zou believes Westerners like the guzheng because it sounds _____ and _____.

exotic / relaxing

Evidence & explanation

Text 2, ¶4: "...because of its **exotic and relaxing** sound."

two blanks, one mark — **BOTH** words must be right.

(1 mark · 59%)

[4] 'Westerners are attracted to it because of its **exotic** and **relaxing** sound. The skill of playing the guzheng brings many benefits, such as artistic expression, sense

Read the paragraph — then write your answer

5. How does the Leisure and Cultural Services Department select students for their guzheng courses?
(passing an) interview and (taking a music aptitude) test

setting and tuition costs HK\$1,000.

55 [10] Acceptance is based on an interview and a music aptitude test with the next intake in August. All classes are conducted in Cantonese.

Evidence & explanation

Text 2, ¶10: "Acceptance is based on an interview and a music aptitude test with the next intake in August."

TWO points — an interview AND a test — write both or lose the mark.

(1 mark · 34%)

Read the paragraph — then write your answer

6. What does the first paragraph suggest about social media?

it questions whether social media is good // it isn't always as good as we think

[1] Social media is great for deepening bonds, making friends, or finding that special someone. Or is it?

Evidence & explanation

Text 3, ¶1: "Social media is great for deepening bonds... Or is it?"
the rhetorical "Or is it?" flips the positive claim — the doubt IS the answer.

(1 mark · 3%)

Read the paragraph — then write your answer

7. According to paragraph 2, what are some users doing by accident?

revealing undesirable personal traits (to their peers)

5 **[2]** New research suggests that so-called power users, who contribute much more content than the average Facebook user, are unwittingly revealing undesirable personal traits to their peers. The recent study also suggests that

Evidence & explanation

Text 3, ¶2: "...power users... are unwittingly revealing undesirable personal traits to their peers."

"by accident" = unwittingly — copy the phrase after it.

(1 mark · 56%)

Read the paragraph — then write your answer

8. In line 15, “This assumption” refers to...

(the idea) that Facebook could be a fantastic place for people to strengthen their relationships

[3] ‘We had this idea that Facebook could be a fantastic place for people to strengthen their relationships,’ says Amanda Forest of the University of Waterloo in Ontario, Canada.

15 [4] This assumption seems fair when applied to most people, especially those with low self esteem. However, the findings of Forest’s

Evidence & explanation

“This assumption” points BACK to ¶3:
“...Facebook could be a fantastic place for people to strengthen their relationships.”

reference words **read backwards** —
copy the earlier idea.

(1 mark • 33%)

Read the paragraph — then write your answer

9. What does “it” (line 41) refer to?

a negative reaction

an indication that they don't like it,' says Forest.
40 But when people have a negative reaction to a
post on Facebook, they seem to keep it to
themselves. 'On Facebook, you don't see most
of the reactions.'

Evidence & explanation

Text 3, ¶8: “...a negative reaction to a post on Facebook, they seem to keep it to themselves.”

“it” points back to the noun before it:
a negative reaction.

(1 mark · 53%)

Read the paragraph — then write your answer

10. Why is Facebook compared to cigarettes and alcohol?

because it is (as) addictive as cigarettes and alcohol // it is an addiction

Evidence & explanation

Text 3, ¶9: "...evidence that Facebook is **as addictive as** cigarettes and alcohol."

comparison question (see demos 1–2): **the shared quality is the answer — addictive.**

(1 mark · 28%)

19] Is Facebook about popularity or
45 desperation? It may often edge towards the
latter, with evidence that Facebook is as
addictive as cigarettes and alcohol. A study of
the activities and desires of 200 adults by the

Read the paragraph — then write your answer

11. i) In what way could social networking websites help people with low self-esteem? ii) In what way can social networking websites be harmful to people with low self-esteem?

i) share things on Facebook // improve their friendships // build self-esteem

Evidence & explanation

ii) bombard friends with negative tidbits // become less likeable

[10] In theory, social networking websites like Facebook could be great for people with low self-esteem. Sharing is important for improving friendships. But in practice, people with low self-esteem seem to behave counterproductively, bombarding their friends with negative tidbits about their lives and making themselves less likeable.

Text 3, #10: "In theory... sharing... But in practice... bombarding their friends with negative tidbits... becoming less likeable."

two parts = two marks — give the "In theory" idea AND the "But in practice" idea.

(2 marks · 48% / 46%)